

## Challenge Name: dns sluth - 100 (Threat Intel L1)

The image shows a 'Challenge Info' window for a challenge named 'dns sluth - 100'. The window has a dark theme. On the left, there's a graphic with the text 'dns sluth 100' and a button labeled 'Description'. To the right of the button, it says '189 Solves'. On the right side of the window, under the 'Description' heading, there's a paragraph: 'A suspicious phishing email claimed to come from support-hackorn.secpen.org - as reported. Goal: Identify the suspicious subdomain that briefly existed.' Below this, it says 'Link: dns\_sluth.zip' and 'Sample: SPL[sone\_random\_text]'. At the bottom right, it says '1/3 attempts'. There are 'Flag' and 'Report' buttons at the bottom right of the window.

Challenge Info

Description

A suspicious phishing email claimed to come from support-hackorn.secpen.org - as reported. Goal: Identify the suspicious subdomain that briefly existed.

Link: dns\_sluth.zip

Sample: SPL[sone\_random\_text]

1/3 attempts

Flag

## Approach

The challenge description mentioned a phishing email from support-hackorn.secpen.org and asked to identify the suspicious subdomain. That implies we should inspect DNS history / passive DNS records in the provided pdns export and look for anomalies (unusual IPs, private addresses, short-lived records, or mismatches with known authoritative ranges).

## What I observed

I opened the pdns file (Excel) and examined the DNS records. A short excerpt:

The image shows an Excel spreadsheet with DNS records. The records are in a table with columns for date, hostname, and IP address. A 'Find and Replace' dialog box is open over the spreadsheet, with 'Find what:' set to 'support-hackorn.secpen.org'. The dialog has 'Find All', 'Find Next', and 'Close' buttons.

|    |           |                 |               |
|----|-----------|-----------------|---------------|
| 67 | 2025-05-0 | backup.secp     | 203.0.5.29    |
| 68 | 2025-05-0 | portal.secp     | 203.0.225.253 |
| 69 | 2025-05-0 | www.secp        | 203.0.62.15   |
| 70 | 2025-05-0 | vpn.secp        | 203.0.225.146 |
| 71 | 2025-05-1 | api.secp        | 203.0.22.188  |
| 72 | 2025-05-1 | backup.secp     | 203.0.209.18  |
| 73 | 2025-05-1 | mail.secp       | 203.0.33.169  |
| 74 | 2025-05-1 | backup.secp     | 203.0.243.141 |
| 75 | 2025-05-1 | support-hackorn | 192.168.43.68 |
| 76 | 2025-05-1 | login.secp      | 203.0.247.55  |
| 77 | 2025-05-1 | vpn.secp        | 203.0.183.80  |

Most secpen.org hostnames resolve to public IPs in the 203.0.x.x space. One entry, however — support-hackorn.secpen.org — resolves to 192.168.43.68, which is a private RFC1918 address. That is suspicious for a publicly observed DNS record and inconsistent with the others.

## Why this is suspicious

- `192.168.x.x` is a private address normally used only inside local networks — it should not appear as the public A record of an Internet-visible subdomain.
- Compared to other records in the file (all public IPs), the private IP is an outlier.
- The challenge prompt referenced `support-hackorn.secpen.org` which matches the suspicious record found.
- Short-lived or inconsistent records (private IPs leaking into PDNS) are typical signs of misconfiguration, attacker-controlled staging, or temporary phishing infrastructure.

## Final

The suspicious subdomain (and the flag) is:

**Flag:** `SPL{support-hackorn.secpen.org}`

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